

Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣K

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣K

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣4

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥J

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠10

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8
 ♥ 9 4 3 2
 ♦ J 9 8
 ♣ A 9 4

♠ Q 7 4 2

♥ Q J 10 7 5

♦ K 6

♣ 8 3



♠ A 6 3

♥ 8

♦ 10 7 5 4 3

♣ K Q J 5

♠ K J 5

♥ A K 6

♦ A Q 2

♣ 10 7 6 2

NORTH, with a 5-card AND a 4-card Major first uses Stayman.

SOUTH denies a 4-card Major, so NORTH realizes that ♠s are out. He then bids ♥s, promising five of them.

SOUTH not only has three ♥s, she also has 17 points so she bids 4♥.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 7 4 2
 ♥ Q J 10 7 5
 ♦ K 7
 ♣ 8 3

♠ 3
 ♥ A 9 8 4 3
 ♦ J 10 8 3
 ♣ Q J 4



♠ A K J 5
 ♥ K 6
 ♦ A Q 6 2
 ♣ 10 7 2

♠ 10 9 8 6
 ♥ 2
 ♦ 9 5 4
 ♣ A K 9 6 5

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			
4♠ by East			
Lead: ♣K			

This is a companion hand to Deal 16.

EAST shows four ♠s following WEST's Stayman bid.

So WEST ignores her five ♥s, having already found an 8-card Major suit fit. With the fit her hand now revalues to 11 points so she bids 4♠.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 8 6
 ♥ A 4
 ♦ J 10 8
 ♣ A 9 6 4

♠ Q 7 4 2
 ♥ Q J 10 7 5
 ♦ K 7
 ♣ 8 3



♠ 10 3
 ♥ 9 8 3 2
 ♦ 9 5 4 3
 ♣ K Q 5

♠ A K 5
 ♥ K 6
 ♦ A Q 6 2
 ♣ J 10 7 2

This is companion #3 to Deal 16 and 17.

NORTH again starts with Stayman, and after SOUTH denies a 4-card Major, NORTH shows her five ♥s.

But in this Deal SOUTH has only a doubleton ♥, so he chooses to play 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♣4			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 10 8 6 5 4

♥ Q 7 5 3

♦ 7

♣ A Q

♠ A 7 3

♥ J 10 8

♦ A 10 8 4 2

♣ 10 5



♠ K J

♥ A K 6

♦ J 9 5 3

♣ K J 9 6

♠ 9 2

♥ 9 4 2

♦ K Q 6

♣ 8 7 4 3 2

Even with a 6-card ♠ suit WEST uses Stayman because he also has a 4-card ♥ suit. Given a choice, playing a 4-4 Major fit is usually preferable to a 6-2 or even a 6-3 fit.

But here EAST doesn't have four ♥s so WEST just bids the game where he knows the partnership holds eight trumps.

*West**North**East**South*

2 ♣

Pass

2 ♦

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥ J

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 5 2
♥ A 7
♦ Q 9 6 3
♣ J 9 4 2

♠ A 7
♥ K J 6 5
♦ A 8 4
♣ K Q 10 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 9 8 6 4
♥ 2
♦ J 10 7 2
♣ 7 6 3

♠ K Q 3
♥ Q 10 9 8 4 3
♦ K 5
♣ A 5

NORTH breaks the expected Transfer sequence by jumping to 3♥ instead of bidding just 2♥. This is called the "Super Accept" and it shows a hand with four of the trump suit with maximum point count.

SOUTH's ♣ bid and NORTH's ♦ bid are Control bids, showing first round control of the suit that was bid.

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♦	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by North			
Lead: ♠ 10			